THE COMMIT BOOK

THE COMMIT BOOK · PLAYBOOK

For athletes considering a two-year college route. Rules checked 2026-11-05 against the 2026-27 NCAA Division I Manual.

Edition 2026-27 · Rules checked 2026-11-05 · Education, not legal advice. No outcome promised.

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1. NJCAA BASICS

The NJCAA governs most two-year college athletics. Its eligibility rules are separate from the NCAA's. `TO VERIFY`: current NJCAA Handbook eligibility and scholarship rules (not checked in this edition).

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2. THE D1 TRANSFER RULES THAT MATTER

Your path depends on whether you were an NCAA **qualifier** out of high school (D1 Bylaw 14.3.1.1).

- **Qualifier:** eligible to compete at D1 after at least one full-time semester or quarter at the two-year college (excluding summer) and a 2.000 GPA (D1 Bylaw 14.5.4.1, rev. 6/24/26 for fall 2026 certifications).
- **Not a qualifier:** must graduate from the two-year college, complete at least 6 semester hours of transferable English, 3 of math/quantitative reasoning and 3 of natural/physical science, with a 2.000 cumulative GPA (D1 Bylaw 14.5.4.2, rev. 6/24/26).
- Baseball, basketball and softball qualifiers who enroll midyear at the D1 school can't compete until the next academic year (D1 Bylaw 14.5.4.1.1).

So: the high school core courses still matter. See *Eligibility: the 2 Hard Deadlines*.

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3. TRANSFER CREDIT PLANNING

Each semester, confirm with the D1 target's admissions office which courses transfer. Transferable is the four-year school's call, not the JUCO's.

4. WHEN FOUR-YEAR COACHES CAN RECRUIT YOU

- A non-qualifier in the first year of full-time JUCO enrollment can't be contacted in person on a D1 campus; off-campus contact only at the two-year college (D1 Bylaw 13.1.1.3).
- Two-year college athletes sign aid agreements in the same signing periods as high school recruits (D1 Bylaw 13.02.13.1); football has a midyear JUCO date, the Wednesday before the first Saturday in December (13.02.13.1(d)).

5. QUESTIONS FOR JUCO COACHES

- How many players moved to four-year programs in the last two years, and where? (Ask for names you can check on rosters.)
- Which of your courses transfer to my target schools?
- Will I graduate in two years on this schedule?

6. CREDIT TRACKER

TERM	COURSE	CREDITS	AREA (ENG/MATH/SCI/OTHER)	GRADE	TRANSFERS TO [SCHOOL]? (CONFIRMED BY)

Running: English ___/6 · Math ___/3 · Science ___/3 · GPA ___ (2.000 minimum)

7. SOURCES

- 2026-27 NCAA Division I Manual, LSDBi 90008, checked 2026-11-05: Bylaws 13.1.1.3, 13.02.13.1(d), 14.3.1.1, 14.5.4, 14.5.4.1, 14.5.4.1.1, 14.5.4.2.
- NJCAA rules: `TO VERIFY` at https://www.njcaa.org (not checked).